

Significantly, the dock is the only place in Mac OS X that has the trash can, so it is pretty important. Though the dock can be set to auto-hide, it cannot be turned off.

Apart from the desktop, there is a new feature in Tiger called the Dashboard, a pretty slick-looking interface that allows you to have mini applications, called widgets, that perform specific (generally Internet-related) tasks. It has some whiz-bang effects that never stop looking cool. Another utility that Apple ships with new Macs nowadays is Front Row, a Windows Media Center-like application that allows you to remote control your Mac from across the room. It has a simple, minimalist interface, but given a choice between functionality and minimalism, we would certainly prefer the former—and Windows Media Center is looking pretty good in Vista. This is one area where Apple needs to up their standards.

Then there is Exposé, the revolutionary window management feature in Mac OS X that allows you to work better with multiple windows while maintaining the coolness factor. It looks and works well, and when compared to Flip 3D in Windows Vista, it effectively crushes Microsoft's hot new feature.

5.3 Functionality And Productivity

Macs are considered unique because they're supposed to inspire creativity, have unrivalled security, are the industry leaders when it comes to design—and can run all operating systems easily. The purpose of this section is to educate you on the number of things you can do with a Macintosh, but a thorough understanding of the subject would require a lot more than a little book. Here we'll look at some of the greatest features of Mac OS X.

5.3.1 Efficient Multi-tasking

Mac OS X offers the following features for managing multiple windows: Exposé, the Dock, and [Command] + [Tab]. The Windows Vista counterparts for these features are Flip 3D, the